



Microsoft Surface

You've probably heard about the Microsoft Surface—it's been all in the news. In case you haven't, it has a 30-inch touchscreen display in a 21-inch box that supports multi-touch; it can be used by many people at once. It lets you pick up elements such as videos and images and drag and drop them around, like you would with a mouse—but only you use your hands! What makes it even more revolutionary is that you can put a digital camera and a mobile phone upon it, and they get detected automatically. You can then view images off the devices, or drag and drop

images from the camera to the phone. We can't do justice to it here—you'll have to see it in action!

We're excited about this kind of computing, but we doubt the Surface is going to end up in your home anytime soon—it's going to cost between \$5,000 and \$10,000 (Rs 2.25 to 4.5 lakh!). We've heard it's going to be out around the end of this year.



Archos 704 WiFi

Whate to say this, but your 2-inch-screen phone is a sad excuse for mobile entertainment, put face to face with the Archos 704 WiFi. You get this device in 40 GB and 80 GB variants; it has a 7-inch touchscreen that supports a resolution of 800 x 480. A wide range of high-quality video formats such as MPEG4, WMV, AAC/H.264/MP4, MPEG2, and VOB are supported. Formats like PDF for books and image formats such as JPG, BMP, and PNG are supported as well. Hook up the optional DVR Station and it will record video streams off your TV; it can also play back media on your TV.

Other than playing music and videos, you can also surf the Net using Opera over the Wi-Fi connection.



And then, you can turn the device into a camcorder by hooking it up to certain digital cameras or to the optional helmet camera (a mini-cam that you can strap on to your head—which sports enthusiasts will love, for example). You can thus take advantage of the large onboard storage. The expected price for the 80 GB 704 is \$550 (Rs 24,750).



Sony HDR-CX6EK

Sony's new obsession seems to be tiny gadgets. Sony claims the HDR-CX6EK HD is the world's smallest and lightest camcorder. It weighs just around 370 gm without the batteries; it can record videos at 1080i and still images at 6.1 MP. 5.1 Dolby surround sound can be recorded using the inbuilt microphone. The 2.7-inch touchscreen is used to view footage and navigate through the interface. You can also connect the device to an HDTV and view your shots using the HDMI interface.

A new feature here is the Face Index, which detects faces from within videos and creates an index so you can look for videos of a particular person by clicking on a thumbnail! The HDR-CX6EK will set you back by \$1200 (Rs 54,000), though.